AI FOR MANAGERS

How to lead teams that use AI – without losing control

Your 60-Day AI Adoption Workbook

Your companion for the course. It holds every exercise you'll do, laid out as a 60-day plan. Fill it in as you go – when it's complete, you'll have a working operating model for AI in your team.

WEEKS 1-2

Assess

Your Team AI Baseline

WEEKS 3-4

Align

Your Team Working Standard

WEEKS 5-6

Control

Your Checkpoint Map

WEEKS 7-8

Lead

Your Lead AI Adoption Plan

THE PLAN

The 60-Day Plan

Four moves, two weeks each. Each one builds on the last.

Weeks	Move	What you build	What it gives you
1–2	**Assess**	Your Team AI Baseline	A clear picture of how your team really uses AI – and where the risk sits
3–4	**Align**	Your Team Working Standard	One shared way of working that everyone has agreed to
5–6	**Control**	Your Checkpoint Map	Checks that catch AI risk before it reaches a decision
7–8	**Lead**	Your Lead AI Adoption Plan (the four roles)	A system that keeps adoption alive and improving

HOW TO USE THIS

Work through one move at a time, in order – each builds on the one before. Fill in the exercises as you go; the boxes and tables are yours to write in. Sixty days is a guide, not a deadline – larger or regulated teams may need longer, and urgent risk controls never wait.

*The full framework grid – each move's question, work, output, and what changes – is in **Appendix E**.*

WEEKS 1-2 · ASSESS

Build Your Team AI Baseline

> GOAL
>
> See what's really happening with AI in your team before you try to change anything.

REFLECTION

Start by noticing

A quick gut-check before you gather any data.

Think about one task your team does regularly — a first draft, a research summary, a weekly status update. How long does it take? What does a good version look like? You have a mental model for all of that. Was it built *before* AI, or *after*?

Do I know which recent outputs involved AI? Could I trace what went wrong if it did? Have we agreed what "reviewed" means?

EXERCISE

Run the AI Baseline Assessment

Find out what AI your team actually uses, where it helps, where capability is shifting, and where the risk sits.

1 Start with yourself first

Run it on yourself before the team: which tools, which tasks, what has changed, what you can still do independently, where your own risks are.

---

2 Frame it for the team

Send this first, so it lands as an invitation, not an audit:

> FRAMING MESSAGE
>
> *"AI has changed how we work, and I don't have a clear enough picture of that yet. I want to understand what's actually happening – so I can support you better and make sure we're set up for this properly as a team."*

3 Then ask each person about the four areas

Follow the default path: written check-in first, one-to-ones where you need depth, then patterns back to the team.

Usage – what's actually happening

Which AI tools are they using? For which tasks? How often? Which tasks do they avoid AI for – and why?

Impact – what's changed

Which parts of the work have become faster? Where has quality changed? What do they spend time on now that they didn't before – and what's dropped away?

Capability – what it means for development

Which skills are they using more, which less? If AI were unavailable for a week, which parts of their work would feel hardest? Can they walk through the reasoning behind a recent piece of work without the document in front of them?

Risk – where the exposure is

Are there types of information they're unsure about putting into AI? What do they do before they use or send AI output? Do they have a consistent checking process? Has AI ever produced something that turned out to be wrong?

Optional – AI Opportunity Scan, if AI use is low. Ask three questions: Which tasks are repetitive, where you produce something similar each week? Where does gathering information take significant time before the

actual thinking? What feels slow or effortful out of proportion to the output? Then check each one: if we improved this, would it materially help the team or the work? Keep only the few worth pursuing.

*The full set of question prompts — organized by the four areas — is in **Appendix B**. Use them as your starting point; you don't need to ask every question. Pick what's most relevant to each person.*

EXERCISE

Write up your Team AI Baseline

Turn the answers into a one-page read of where each person and the team stand.

Rate each area: ●○○ limited · ●●○ developing · ●●● strong

Person	Usage	Impact	Capability	Risk	Notes
Team					

This is not a performance rating — it's your current read. The categories where the team scores lowest are where you're most exposed right now.

Tip: writing up the summaries is a good task to do with AI. Paste your notes from each conversation into an approved tool — within your organization's data rules — and ask it to organize them across the four areas.

EXERCISE

Start Reinforce

Your first signal that experimenting with AI is safe.

Share one imperfect moment from your own AI use.

The moment I'll share

WEEKS 3-4 · ALIGN

Build Your Team Working Standard

GOAL

Turn what you learned in Assess into a shared way of working – one the team helps build and confirms.

How to introduce it: open the session so people know it's collaborative, not a restriction:

SESSION OPENER

"The baseline gave us a picture of how we're actually working. Some of it is working well. Some of it isn't. I want us to build a shared standard using what we learned. I need your input because you know how the work happens – and I remain accountable for the final decisions."

EXERCISE

Set the Five Agreements

Agree, as a team, the basic rules for how everyone works with AI. Keep each to one or two sentences.

1 Tools – what may be used

Which are approved? Which aren't? How do we handle a new one?

2 Data – what may be entered

What never goes in? The rule when unsure? When in doubt, leave it out.

3 Review – what must receive human judgment before it's used or shared

Does the expectation differ for internal vs. external work?

4 Disclosure – when AI involvement must be made visible

What triggers telling the manager?

5 Direction and Support – where AI should add value

Which capabilities must stay strong? What support do people need?

EXERCISE

Define Your Key Workflows

Make your most important AI-involved tasks explicit and consistent.

Only worth doing where several people do the same task, or the output matters because it goes to clients, informs decisions, or is used by others. Pick one to start – two or three over time.

For each, map how it runs now by answering a short set of questions: what starts the task, where AI enters, what information it uses, what it produces, where human judgment or verification happens, and who remains accountable. Then run a five-agreements check, and agree the approach you want. The **Workflow Description Template** in Appendix C gives you the fill-in structure.

Workflow 1

Workflow 2 (optional)

EXERCISE

Activate the Standard

Put it where work happens and use it for real, so it doesn't gather dust.

Where it lives (in the flow, not a folder)

How I'll introduce it

The first real moment I'll refer to it

KEEP IT CURRENT

Once a quarter, ask "Is anything here no longer working, unclear, or outdated?" Revisit sooner if a new tool arrives, the work changes, or you notice the standard is no longer being followed in practice. (This later folds into the single quarterly review you'll book in Lead.)

EXERCISE

Start Develop

A first conversation to see where one person is and agree a next step.

Open with:

> OPENING QUESTION
>
> *"Walk me through how you've been using AI on your work recently."*

Make a rough read, then agree one step. The **Develop Reference Card** in the appendix has the full set of signals, questions, and task ideas.

Person	Where they are	Next step

WEEKS 5-6 · CONTROL

Build Your Checkpoint Map

GOAL

Put checks inside your workflows at the exact moments AI risk could enter.

EXERCISE

Spot where AI could reach a decision unchecked

Notice where an AI claim could drive a decision with no one verifying it.

Pick one recent piece of AI-assisted work that informed a decision, and ask: What's the key claim it rested on? Was it generated by AI, or from a verified source? Who verified it before it reached you?

What I found

EXERCISE

Run the checkpoint scan

At the moments where the three risks pass through the work — is there a check? And is it named?

Decisions — where AI-assisted work feeds a decision: is anyone named to verify the key claims before it gets there?

Data — where sensitive material could go into a tool: is there a moment where someone asks "should this go in?" — or does it rely on people remembering?

External output — where work leaves the team: does it get a sharper check than internal work — or the same one?

You're not fixing anything yet. You're finding the spots where the answer is "nobody" or "nothing" — those gaps are the raw material for the Checkpoint Map.

EXERCISE

Build the Checkpoint Map

Place a simple check at each moment AI risk could enter the work.

For each risk area ask: where could risk enter and reach a consequence? What's the simplest check (under two minutes)? Who applies it? Write one line each – **When → What → Who**.

When – the moment	What gets checked	Who

IF A WORKFLOW USES AN AI AGENT

Also check what it's allowed to do before it starts, and whether you can see what it did after. Confirm with the team, and use it the first time something relevant crosses your desk.

WEEKS 7-8 · LEAD

Activate the Four Roles

GOAL

Bring all four Lead roles into operation. Reinforce and Develop are already underway; Amplify and Scout come online now. Your entries below are your **Lead AI Adoption Plan**.

EXERCISE · LEAD

Reinforce

Keep adoption alive through the signals you repeat.

Scan the four levers – for each, ask yourself: *am I already doing this, or not really?* Then pick the one you're weakest on and use it once this week, in a real conversation, review, or meeting.

Vision
Do I say out loud what AI is for – and where we're heading with it – in real work moments?

Recognition
When someone makes a smart call with AI, do I name it?

Asking
Do I ask *how* people worked, or only whether it got done?

Modeling
Have I recently shown the team my own AI use – what I tried, and how it actually went?

The lever I'll use this week, and how

Process questions worth asking regularly: "What did you use AI for on this?" · "Walk me through how you worked on this." · "Where did you make the judgment call?" · "Where did you check the output?" · "What would you do differently?"

EXERCISE · LEAD

Develop

Move each person forward from where they actually are.

Open with *"Walk me through how you've been using AI on your work recently."* Listen for the pattern, then agree one concrete next step together:

- **Exploring** – ahead of the team, brings up examples unprompted, asking what's next.
- **Complying** – does it, but vague; no real examples, low energy.
- **Resisting** – hesitation, "it doesn't really fit my work," pauses.
- **Struggling** – tried it, it didn't work, confidence dropping.

*Exploring? "What have you figured out that the rest of the team doesn't know yet?" · Resisting? "What's making this feel uncertain for you – specifically?" The full set – all four patterns with signals, questions, task ideas, and follow-up timing – is in the **Develop Reference Card** in the appendix.*

Person	Where they are	Evidence	Next step	Follow-up

EXERCISE · LEAD

Amplify

Turn one person's useful find into something the whole team can use.

Listen for finds in the conversations you already have – one-to-ones, task discussions – and give the learning question a recurring home:

> **THE LEARNING QUESTION**
>
> *"Has anyone learned something about using AI since we last asked – something that worked, something that didn't, something worth sharing?"*

Take one finding through: **Surface** → **Examine** → **Spread** → **Retain** – with the person; it's their find, you guide it.

To examine: what was it for, tried here or seen elsewhere? What worked or failed? Once or every time? What did you change? Where would you not use it?

Where the question will live

One finding I'm guiding – what it was, what we learned, and how far it got

EXERCISE · LEAD

Scout

Look, on purpose, for where AI could add real value next.

Run one scan: a slow step, a recurring rework problem, a bottleneck, a tool that's added a new capability, a competitor moving faster. Put your best candidate through two questions: would fixing it genuinely help, and is the gain worth the setup and checking?

Candidate

Worth trialling? Owner, end date, and what the trial needs to learn

Nothing cleared the bar? Write "nothing worth pursuing right now" — and why. That's a real result, not a blank

✓ Book the quarterly review

The recurring check that keeps the whole system current. The 15–20 minute agenda — the four-role self-check and the team snapshot — is in **Appendix D**.

Date (about three months out)

THE RESULT

What You'll Have at the End

When the workbook is full, you have a complete operating model for AI in your team:

A Team AI Baseline
What's happening across usage, impact, capability, and risk

A Team Working Standard
Five agreements and your key workflows

A Checkpoint Map
The checks that protect decisions, data, and external trust

A Lead AI Adoption Plan
The four roles that keep adoption alive and growing

NOT FOUR DOCUMENTS IN A DRAWER

A shared way of working with AI that's managed, not improvised. From here, the quarterly review keeps it current.

APPENDIX A

Develop Reference Card

Keep this next to you before and during a development one-to-one. You don't need to memorize it — glance at it.

Open every development conversation with:

> OPENING QUESTION
>
> *"Walk me through how you've been using AI on your work recently."*

Not "are you using AI?" — that gets a yes or no. "Walk me through" gets a real picture; a sense of where they are usually forms as they talk. Then listen for one of four positions — starting reads, not fixed labels. People move between them as they learn.

Exploring

Signals: Ahead of the team. Specific examples, unprompted. Asks what's next.

Risk: Their learning stays private; they feel unseen.

Next step: Stretch them and make their work visible — e.g., bring one thing they've figured out to the next team meeting.

Question: *"What have you figured out that the rest of the team doesn't know yet?"*

Follow up: ~2 weeks — what they brought, and how it landed.

Complying

Signals: Does it, but vague. No real examples. Low energy — "I use it for drafts," no detail.

Risk: The rule stays a rule and never becomes practice they believe in.

Next step: Connect AI to something they'd actually like to change about their work — a specific starting point, not "experiment more."

Question: *"What part of your work do you wish took less time?"*

Follow up: ~2 weeks — what they found, and what they decided about when to trust the output.

Resisting

Signals: Hesitation. "It doesn't really fit my work." Vague answers, pauses.

Risk: The real concern stays underground; pushing buries it further.

Next step: Surface the concern first, then meet it – job/role fear (name where their judgment stays irreplaceable), quality worry (show the verification checkpoint), skill gap (pair with a colleague; take the stakes off the first try).

Question: *"What's making this feel uncertain for you – specifically?"*

Follow up: ~2–3 weeks – *"Has anything shifted since we talked?"* (not "are you using AI now?").

Struggling

Signals: Tried it, it didn't work. "I've tried but…" Confidence dropping.

Risk: Repeated failure erodes confidence until they give up. Practical and immediate helps; encouragement doesn't.

Next step: Find the specific barrier, then pick one task they can win at – prompt structure (five minutes with a colleague), wrong task type (one task where AI works reliably for their work), skill gap (one targeted step with a clear output).

Question: *"Where exactly does it break down for you?"*

Follow up: ~1 week – not two; confidence erodes fast. *"Did you try it? What happened?"* Name any partial win.

DOING WELL – NO POSITION NEEDED

Some people just have it: real examples, good judgment, steady progress. Don't force a pattern. Name it, agree a step that keeps them going, and move on.

CLOSING ANY STEP – THE THREE-PART TEST

The step can be a small task or a real piece of work. Before you finish, you should both be able to say: *what* they'll try, on *what work*, and *when* you'll talk about how it went. If not, it isn't a step yet.

APPENDIX B

AI Baseline Assessment – Question Prompts

The full set, organized by the four areas. Use them as your starting point – you don't need to ask every question; pick what's most relevant to each person.

Usage – what is actually happening

Which AI tools do you use in your work, and for which tasks? · How often – regularly, occasionally, or rarely? · Are there tasks you've tried AI for and stopped? What happened? · Are there tasks you haven't tried AI for yet? Any particular reason?

Impact – what has changed

Which parts of your work have become faster or easier? · Has the quality of your work changed in any area – in either direction? · Are there steps that used to happen separately that now happen in one go with AI?

Capability – what it means for development

Which skills feel like you're using them more than before? Which less? · If AI were unavailable for a week, which parts of your work would feel hardest? · Can you walk me through how you approached a specific recent piece of work – what you decided to include, what you cut, and why? · Are there things you could do without AI six months ago that feel harder today?

Risk – where the exposure is

Are there types of information you're cautious about putting into AI tools? · What do you do before you use or send AI-assisted output – do you have a consistent checking process? · Has AI ever produced something that turned out to be wrong or misleading?

Optional add-on – the AI Opportunity Scan

Only if your team's AI use is genuinely low (check first: low, or just invisible?). Ask each person three questions:

- Which tasks in your work are repetitive – where you produce something similar each week?
- Where does gathering or pulling together information take significant time before you can do the actual thinking?
- What feels slow or effortful in a way that doesn't feel proportionate to the output?

The answers produce a raw list, not recommendations. Before carrying an item forward, ask one light impact question: *if we improved this, would it materially help the team or the work?* Keep only the few where the answer may be yes. Don't choose a tool yet – start with the work and the potential value.

APPENDIX C

Workflow Description Template

One page per workflow. Map how the task actually runs now — then run the five-agreements check across it, and agree the approach you want.

Workflow name

Question	How it runs
What starts the task	
Where AI enters	
What information it uses	
What it produces	
Where human judgment / verification happens	
Who remains accountable	

Five-agreements check — anything flagged, and what we agreed

Tip from the lesson: let AI write up the workflow description from your notes — you check and confirm it with the team. Copy this page for a second workflow.

APPENDIX D

Quarterly Review – Leadership Self-Check

Use this quarterly, alongside the quarterly review. 15–20 minutes. Fill in Part 1 before the meeting; bring Part 2 into your one-to-ones. Not a performance document – a check on whether the four Lead roles are actually running.

Part 1 – Four-role self-check

For each lever, ask one question: *when did I last do this – specifically?* If you can't name a specific instance, the lever isn't running.

Reinforce	Self-check question	Last time (specific)
Vision	When did I last connect AI use to what it specifically enables for this team's work?	
Recognition	When did I last name a specific behavior – not just good output?	
Asking	When did I last ask someone how they approached their work, rather than just how it went?	
Modeling	When did I last share a learning moment from my own AI use – including what didn't work?	

Develop	Self-check question	Last time (specific)
Understand	When did I last open a conversation with "walk me through how you've been using AI on your work recently" – and just listen for where they are?	
Agree a step	When did I last agree a position-specific next step with someone (see Appendix A) – what they'll try, on what work, and when we'll talk?	
Follow up	When did I last check back on an agreed step at the agreed time – and adjust if my first read was wrong?	

Amplify	Self-check question	Last time (specific)
Surface	Is the learning question still a standing slot? When did I last answer it myself – with something that didn't work?	

Examine	When did I last sit down with someone to pin down what their find is actually good for – and where not?	
Spread	When did I last help a find reach the others – a demo, a short workshop, a pairing, a low-risk test?	
Retain	When was the last kept find captured where the team already looks?	

Scout	Self-check question	Last time (specific)
Look	When did I last ask where we're losing time or ground – and whether anyone has tried AI for something we haven't picked up?	
Filter & trial	When did I last put a candidate through the two impact questions – and run a bounded trial when it cleared the bar?	
Decide	When did the last trial end in an explicit decision – adopt, hold, or a call above my level?	

WHAT TO DO WITH THE RESULTS

Pick one lever that isn't running. Make one use of it this week. This isn't meant to produce a fourteen-item to-do list – it surfaces the one or two levers that have quietly gone dormant.

Part 2 – Team snapshot

Where does each person stand right now? Positions: Exploring / Complying / Resisting / Struggling / Unclear. Evidence means one or two specific things you heard or observed – not a general impression. The next move is the position-specific step from Appendix A.

Team member	Current position	Evidence	Next move	By when

AFTER THE REVIEW

Reactivate one dormant lever this week. Update one-to-one plans for anyone whose position changed. Keep the two Scout questions on the quarterly review agenda: "Where are we losing time or ground?" and "Has anyone tried AI for something we haven't picked up?" And note in one sentence what this review surfaced — it becomes the starting point for the next one.

APPENDIX E

The Team AI Integration Framework

Assess → Align → Control → Lead *– four moves, each building on the last.*

	Assess Restore the picture.	**Align** Create a shared way of working.	**Control** Restore trust in the work.	**Lead** Build genuine adoption and capability.
YOUR QUESTION	What is actually happening across my team?	How should our team work with AI?	Where must human judgment and checking protect the work?	How do I help the team use, improve, and learn within the agreed approach?
THE WORK	Gather evidence across Usage, Impact, Capability, and Risk.	Agree team expectations and describe how AI fits into important workflows.	Place clear checks at the points where AI risk could reach a consequence.	Reinforce the approach, develop each person, amplify useful learning, and scout for meaningful improvements.
YOU BUILD	**Team AI Baseline**	**Team Working Standard**	**Checkpoint Map**	**Lead AI Adoption Plan**
INSIDE IT	Usage, Impact, Capability, and Risk	**Layer 1: The Five Agreements** – Tools, Data, Review, Disclosure, Direction and Support. **Layer 2:** Shared Workflows	When → What → Who – the moment, the check, the owner	The four roles – **Reinforce, Develop, Amplify, Scout** – plus the quarterly review
WHAT CHANGES	Assumptions become a current, evidence-based picture.	Individual variation becomes a shared team process.	General caution becomes specific workflow control.	A static standard becomes an active, improving management system.

Orientation – what changed and why this is management work · **The Framework** – the four moves above · **Capstone** – everything assembled into action

All four come together in your 60-Day Plan